

KEN GIRKIN

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INFORMATION TECHNOLOGY LEADER

CONTINUOUS PROCESS IMPROVEMENT | CLOUD COMPUTING | MANAGEMENT STRATEGIES | TECHNICAL LEADERSHIP

Accomplished IT technician & mentor eager to leverage experience and leadership in managing a full range of complex IT systems and solutions in high-growth environments. Excels at technology and process improvement, increased efficiency and business growth organization wide. Draws on a background aligning work in multiple, concurrent projects. Organizationally agile in project management and technical leadership while fostering strong relationships at all levels of an organization. Facilitated communication between multiple departments to meet needs and maximize capabilities. Motivated self-starter implementing processes and technology to support data driven decisions while balancing technical abilities while solving complex IT issues. Leads proactively while building and maintaining high-performing teams through recruitment, training, and professional development. Highly skilled with infrastructure modernization, creating and launching new systems, analyzing systems requirements, and providing network support to clients in rapidly changing, dynamic environments.

EDUCATION

Master of Science, Cyber Security, Summa Cum Laude, Southern New Hampshire University

Bachelor of Science, IT Management, Magna Cum Laude, Southern New Hampshire University

Associates of Applied Science, Network Administrator, Northwest Vista College

CERTIFICATIONS

Scrum Master Certification (SMC) – August 2024, SCRUMstudy

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

VANTAGE POINT TITLE – CLEARWATER, FL

INFORMATION TECHNOLOGY MANAGER

December 2022 – July 2024

Lead role expertly managing the IT department, including developing and implementing IT strategies aligned with goals and objectives. Planned and oversaw ongoing IT project management, ensuring on time delivery within scope and budget.

- Provided leadership and mentoring to a team of 3 professionals, fostering growth and collaboration
- Successfully migrated IT infrastructure from unstable corporate office to data center, resulting in a stable and reliable environment capable of withstanding power outages.
- Reduced phone system costs by 75% and drastically improved service by replacing it with a new provider during renewal.
- Oversaw management of IT infrastructure, including hardware, software, networks, and data centers.
- Planned, managed, and coordinated day-to-day IT operations according to VPT policies
- Hired, trained, and evaluated staff.
- Expertly communicated IT strategies, policies, and project statuses to senior management and other stakeholders.
- Designed, developed and implemented IT policies and procedures to ensure data security and compliance with regulations.
- Negotiated and managed contracts with IT vendors and service providers while targeting cost-savings and efficiencies.
- Evaluated and selected new tools, technologies and products improving IT services while ensuring IT systems complied with legal, regulatory, and organizational policies.
- Recommend and implement new technologies and processes improving organizational efficiency and effectiveness.

DIOCESE OF ST. PETERSBURG – ST. PETERSBURG, FL
DIRECTOR OF INFORMATION TECHNOLOGY & SECURITY
April 2021 – December 2022

Key role planning, managing, and overseeing day-to-day operations of the Office for Information Technology while meeting established policies. Oversaw support for the MSP (Managed Service Provider) tasked while managing the Pastoral Center and computing services.

- Directed the efforts of 2 team members, aligning their work with organizational objectives.
- Transformed outdated phone system, implementing new IP technology, increasing functionality and allowing work calls on cell phones, resulting in 30% cost savings and improved job performance.
- Improved day-to-day ticket handling and increased response time for users by 15% by outsourcing IT department to MSP, saving 2 positions and ensuring smooth transition from System Administrator to Director of IT.
- for the Pastoral Center, Bethany Center, Calvary Cemetery and WBVM in conjunction with the MSP.
- Expertly advised parishes, schools, and diocesan agencies in applying information technology to meet organizational needs.
- Facilitated the IT needs, security and backup for Pastoral Center, Bethany center, Calvary cemetery, WVBM and the MSP.
- Project managed and maintained hardware and software as well as diocesan information systems.
- Organized and managed the Office for Information Technology operating and capital expenditure budgets.
- Designed and implemented data backup plan for all managed entities in conjunction with the MSP.

SYSTEM ADMINISTRATOR
December 2019 – March 2021

Successfully managed support for all aspects of customer IT environments in a 24x7 support scope, while ensuring and maintaining all IT support needs for the pastoral center and three other locations.
Select Accomplishments:

- Oversaw Zendesk ticket queue and escalations, managed servers, firewalls, switches, and backups for all locations.
- Researched, analyzed and recommended new tools, technologies and improvements for rapidly changing environments.
- Maintained and ensured local and remote support for end users, while managing Active Directory, DHCP, DNS, Group Policies for all environments.
- Supported the pastoral center and 3 other locations for all IT support needs
- Supported all aspects of customers' IT environments in a 24x7 support scope

DXC-CONCERTO – TAMPA, FL
TECHNICAL TEAM LEAD
June 2018 – December 2019

Provided leadership experience supporting 600 customers in multiple Azure, VMWare, Citrix and managed service environments. Maintained and ensured support for all aspects of customers' IT environments in a 24x7 scope.

- Led a team of 10, providing guidance and performance feedback
- Played a key role in the design, testing, and implementation of new ServiceNow features and upgrades
- Designed a new process significantly improving technician data ticket input and tabulating, saving about an hour daily
- Provided coaching, technical assistance, and ticket escalation for team members
- Managed Service Now ticket queues for multiple teams, route tickets to technicians, and escalations
- Audit all Service Desk tickets for compliance & provide statistics to the manager
- Evaluated Service Desk processes targeting compliance gaps and recommending improvements and solutions.
- Created a program utilized to evaluate and audit new environment builds prior to go live for compliance
- Designed the processing and onboarding program for new employees in the Operations Department
- Acknowledged on multiple occasions by Executive Leadership for going above and beyond to support customers

REIMAGINE OFFICE FURNISHINGS – TAMPA, FL

NETWORK ADMINISTRATOR

March 2017 – June 2018

Gained valuable experience managing Windows Active Directory, Exchange 2010 / Office 365, DNS, DHCP, and providing a wide range of IT support for all employees.

- Built an entire IT infrastructure for the new corporate office, including server room, data drops, layout for wireless for corporate office and warehouses; negotiated a network connection doubling network speed for half the cost.
- Provided fast network connection and launched the first warehouse wi-fi, allowing use of wireless scanner guns for inventory.
- Expertly managed SysPro ERP, AutoCAD & 2020 CAP software, Azure, Symantec, Acronis backups, spam filters and antivirus.
- Utilized Project Management skills while implementing; managed the Digium Switchvox phone system

BANKERS FINANCIAL CORPORATION – ST. PETERSBURG, FL

DESKTOP SUPPORT SPECIALIST II

June 2016 – March 2017

- Manage Windows Active Directory, SCCM, Exchange 2010, Office365 Administration
- Manage Avaya VOIP systems for new & existing users
- Provide Tier II & Tier III Support to more than 500 employees in an Enterprise environment
- Manage and maintain Microsoft System Center Configuration Manager
- Track and maintain accountability of work through Manage Engine ticketing system
- Image & deploy desktop computers & laptops

HVHC – SAN ANTONIO, TX

DESKTOP TECHNOLOGY SUPPORT SPECIALIST

February 2013 – February 2016

- Trained & managed more than 30 contractors for various projects with strict deadlines
- Manage Windows Active Directory, SCCM, DNS, DHCP, Exchange
- Provide Tier II & Tier III Support to more than 8000 employees in a nationwide Enterprise environment
- Track and maintain accountability of work through HEAT, MS SCSM, & Remedy ticketing systems
- Played a key role in the implementation of new EMR software
- Image & deploy desktop computers, laptops, and servers
- Created knowledge base library including more than 250 documents
- Played key role in enterprise-wide server replacement
 - o More than 600 servers & 8,000 pieces of hardware
 - o Created all instructional documentation for the project
 - o Trained all other personnel on policies & procedures

SKILLS

IT Management Strategies
Project Management
Technology Leadership
Cost/Benefit Analysis & ROI
Cloud Computing
Cybersecurity & Protocols
Strategic Planning
Resource Management
Teambuilding & Mentorship
Innovative Solutions
Performance Reporting
Process Improvement
Client Relations
Cross-Functional Collaboration
Data Management